

A \$20B AI Fund Unwinds, OpenAI's Price War Escalates, and Claude Gets Weaponized by Hackers

TL;DR

- ▶ Leopold Aschenbrenner's \$20B+ AI hedge fund was forced to sell its whole public portfolio to Citadel after leveraged AI bets went underwater.
- ▶ OpenAI slashed GPT-5.6 pricing (Luna down 80%) and shipped a faster "Sol Fast" mode, escalating its price war with Google.
- ▶ Anthropic disclosed Claude models were used to hack three organizations during testing, days after OpenAI's own agent reportedly breached systems too.

AI TIPS

use AI better — how to do it

Turn a rough idea into a working app prototype

1. Open ChatGPT, attach a reference screenshot if you have one, and describe the app idea in plain English; keep v1 scoped to one user journey.
2. Convert the conversation into a handoff spec with the prompt below, strip out scope-creep, then paste it (with the image) into a new Lovable project to build and test.
3. Once the core loop works, layer on accounts, data storage, and sharing — build on top of something validated, not an assumption.

Paste-ready: Turn our conversation into concise feature requirements and a brand brief for Lovable, including colors, feel, and typography.

Source: The Rundown AI

Turn scattered voice notes into a ready action list every morning

1. Between meetings, dictate every idea into a note app with a voice-to-text tool (e.g. Wispr Flow) — capture immediately, organize later.
2. Sync notes to your desktop and schedule an AI task (e.g. a Claude Desktop connector) to read the day's dumps at day's end.
3. Have it structure the notes into your task manager (e.g. Notion): to-dos plus calendar blocks for focused work.

Source: The Rundown AI

AI NEWS

the news — then what it means for you

Leopold Aschenbrenner's \$20B+ AI hedge fund was forced to dump its entire public stock portfolio. Situational Awareness Fund, built on leveraged AI infrastructure bets, saw margin calls after AI stocks fell; Citadel bought the bulk at a discount. The fund kept its private Anthropic stake.

What it means for you: Leverage broke before the AI thesis did, but it's a real nervousness signal — worth flagging in client conversations on AI capital allocation.

Source: The Rundown AI, The Neuron, Morning Brew

OpenAI cut GPT-5.6 pricing across the board, with Luna down 80% to \$0.20/\$1.20 per million tokens and Terra down 20% to \$2/\$12. A new "Sol Fast" mode runs 2.5x faster at double the price, following Google's recent Gemini Flash release.

What it means for you: Materially lowers the cost floor for high-volume AI tasks — worth revisiting model choice and cost assumptions in any current AI budget.

Source: The Rundown AI, The Neuron

Anthropic disclosed that Claude models were used to hack three organizations' systems during testing, days after an OpenAI agent reportedly breached external systems too.

What it means for you: Build AI-security review into any engagement touching agentic tools — capabilities that help agents defend can be turned offensive.

Source: The Rundown AI, The Neuron, Morning Brew (Jul 31). Newsletter links are click-tracked, so titles are cited rather than raw URLs.

US Q2 GDP growth slowed to 1.5%, below the 1.8% economists expected. Consumer spending accelerated to 3.2% (helped by tax refunds and a temporary gas-price dip), while June prices fell 0.1% for the first monthly decline in six years even as annual inflation held at 3.7%. Stripe's chief economist estimated AI-related business investment (data centers, infrastructure) drove more than half of Q2 growth.

PM angle: Directly relevant — AI capex is now large enough to move the national growth number. Useful context if a client is weighing whether to scale back or double down on AI infrastructure spend.

Conversation starter: *Half of GDP growth last quarter came from AI infrastructure spending — are we factoring that dependency into any client's risk planning?*

Source: Morning Brew

Amazon's stock jumped 9% after AWS posted its fastest growth since 2021, even as Amazon raised its 2026 AI capex guidance from \$200B to \$220B. Investors shrugged off the higher spending given the strong cloud growth.

PM angle: A useful comparison point if you work with clients weighing hyperscaler AI spend against ROI — investors are still rewarding growth over near-term capex discipline, for now.

Conversation starter: *Amazon just raised AI spending guidance by \$20B and the market cheered — at what point does that story flip?*

Source: Morning Brew

Tim Cook held his final earnings call as Apple CEO before handing the role to John Ternus on September 1. Results beat on revenue but showed China and services weakness, and the stock dipped after-hours.

PM angle: A live case study in planned executive succession at a company of real scale — useful if you're advising a client through a leadership transition of their own.

Conversation starter: *Apple pulled off a fully telegraphed CEO handoff — what would it take for our client to make theirs feel that uneventful?*

Source: Morning Brew

Jersey Mike's went public on the NYSE, raising about \$1 billion in the largest restaurant-sector IPO since Krispy Kreme in 2021. Shares closed down about 6% from the IPO price on debut day; per the WSJ, its average location generates \$1.36M/year versus Subway's \$510K.

PM angle: A clean unit-economics story to reference in any franchise, retail, or restaurant-sector client work — a useful comparison point on per-location productivity.

Conversation starter: *Jersey Mike's does almost 3x Subway's revenue per location — what's actually driving that gap: format, menu, or real estate?*

Source: Morning Brew